



birds. What started as a joke sparked by a stock image of a goose in a company's internal communications gave birth to this satirical masterpiece about a goose and its shenanigans, often malevolent. The game is set in a tidy, minimalist English village whose inhabitants are the perfect foil for the game's goose. You'll find those who will fight back, waving arms to keep you at bay; others who will cover their mouths and shield their necks as they cower in terror and disbelief at the very thought of your antics. Being entrusted with the command of this feathery monster and given a list of funny, nefarious duties to fulfil is what makes this game an absolute comedic gem.

SURGEON SIMULATOR

If you go in thinking this is a "simulator," you'll be let down. To put it simply, Surgeon Simulator is 2008 flash game QWOP's spirit applied to surgery. It's about inept organ removal, with the player rendered comically ineffective thanks to an intentionally incorrect physics model making it outrageously dumb. Yet it manages to



be annoyingly entertaining at the same time. When playing Surgeon Simulator, most amusement comes from watching how even the simplest of procedures go awry.

GOAT SIMULATOR

The game's title, which had caused some amusing misunderstanding



when it was first released, was due to the surge in popularity of more detailed simulations like Euro Truck Simulator and Farming Simulator. It's both a spoof of gaming and a parody of itself. It is a joke of a game, which along with Surgeon Simulator, kicked off the joke simulator genre of games. It's tiny, unpolished, and buggy on purpose, with a basic design. It's a pretty amusing joke with lots of excellent physics-powered slapstick humour and surprises around every corner of its deceptively calm small-town map.

SAINTS ROW SERIES

The Saints Row series has anchored the comedic side of the spectrum since GTA IV pushed the franchise towards a more realistic style tale. Before Saints Row: The Third, the franchisee was regarded as a poor man's GTA. The Third instalment revamped what the series stood for, with over-the-top gameplay involving an outlandish mafia tale. SR4 is essentially the same parody-filled third-person action game with an extra punch, with the narrative quickly escalating from



trifling mafia matters to bringing down a nuclear missile and eventually fighting off an alien evasion. It succeeds because it is so ridiculous and generously sprinkled with well-executed jokes and allusions.

THERE IS NO GAME

The game contains a strong blend of meta-commentary on classic video game clichés and plain old-fashioned Lemony Snicket-style reverse psychology. The underlying joke of There Is No Game is that it is a video game



trying to convince you that it is not a video game and should be promptly closed down and removed from your computer. This is a point-and-click adventure game with appealing visuals and a lot of refinement. The game understands the clichés it is mocking quite well, and the way it allows you to fiddle with its interface can be downright amazing at times. There Is No Game necessitates logical yet lateral thinking as you attempt to solve its tangled puzzles while the AI natters and scolds your best attempts.

DEVOLVER BOOTLEG

The apparent vibes it gives off is that of a bootleg Famicom/NES multi-cart full of knockoffs. However, they are far superior. It includes 8 of Devolver's most popular titles, each game being a little out of whack spin on a Devolver Digital franchise, with some being a touch more abstract than others. Each will give you 15-20 minutes of gameplay, but others will go into an endless mode, allowing you to grind up whatever scores you desire. The majority of their names are parodies or derivatives of the game that inspired them. Hotline Milwaukee, for example, is clearly intended to resemble Hotline Miami. *